



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 11

# GEORGIA

## WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

*Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Georgia's family courts and child-welfare system.*

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# 77

GEORGIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 139  
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 17 MONTHS  
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING  
TIME

REPORT GENERATED  
MAY 12, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED  
39 OF 159

COMPILED BY  
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · GEORGIA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Georgia. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Lakendra slade

CPS WORKER · BEN HILL COUNTY DFCS · 3 FAMILIES

Marlo Ross

JUDGE · PIERCE · 3 FAMILIES

**Public threshold rule:** Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

# GEORGIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 77 Georgia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

|                                                                                                |                                                                                                                   |                                                                          |                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>CHILDREN IMPACTED</div> <div>139</div> <div>76 of 77 families reported child counts</div> | <div>MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN</div> <div>\$122,000</div> <div>median across 39 families reporting 3+ categories</div> | <div>MEDIAN MONTHS LOST</div> <div>17</div> <div>of parenting time</div> | <div>WENT PRO SE</div> <div>44.2%</div> <div>28.6% after running out of money</div> |
| <div>SUBMISSIONS</div> <div>77</div>                                                           | <div>AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY</div> <div>1.8</div>                                                                   | <div>FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN</div> <div>76 of 77</div>               | <div>COUNTIES REPRESENTED</div> <div>39</div>                                       |

## WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Georgia families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

### 03 THE COST OF GEORGIA FAMILY COURT

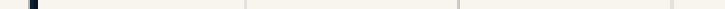
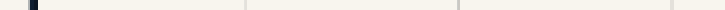
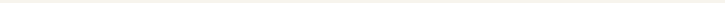
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

| Expense Category                                           | Responses | Median    | Mean     | Total Reported |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|----------|----------------|
| Attorney Fees                                              | 52        | \$21,500  | \$90,128 | \$4,686,654    |
| Lost Wages                                                 | 45        | \$10,000  | \$67,579 | \$3,041,076    |
| Other Court Fees                                           | 32        | \$1,025   | \$3,094  | \$99,000       |
| Therapy / Evaluations                                      | 44        | \$2,250   | \$3,394  | \$149,325      |
| Reunification Services                                     | 29        | \$0       | \$2,914  | \$84,500       |
| GAL Fees                                                   | 37        | \$3,000   | \$7,026  | \$259,950      |
| Asset Loss <sup>1</sup>                                    | 42        | \$30,000  | —        | —              |
| Median Family Burden (39 families reporting 3+ categories) | —         | \$122,000 | —        | —              |

**Median vs. mean:** Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

**1. On asset loss:** One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

### LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

|                           |                                                                                      |       |           |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------|
| Median months lost        |  | 17    | 1.4 yrs   |
| Mean months lost          |  | 35    | 2.9 yrs   |
| Total across all families |  | 1,939 | 161.6 yrs |

## 04 WHO IS REPORTING · GEORGIA

Most families documenting in Georgia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

## CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

## CASE STATUS

|                                    |  |    |     |
|------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Active case: stuck or delayed      |  | 33 | 43% |
| Not provided                       |  | 20 | 26% |
| Case closed: within last 2 years   |  | 11 | 14% |
| Not in court but still affected    |  | 5  | 6%  |
| Case closed: more than 2 years ago |  | 4  | 5%  |

## SYSTEM AFFECTED

|                                      |  |    |     |
|--------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Family Court Only                    |  | 38 | 49% |
| Both Family Court and CPS            |  | 28 | 36% |
| Unknown                              |  | 6  | 8%  |
| CPS (Child Protective Services) Only |  | 4  | 5%  |

## DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

## TIME IN SYSTEM

|                   |  |    |     |
|-------------------|--|----|-----|
| 1 – 3 years       |  | 20 | 26% |
| 6 months – 1 year |  | 16 | 21% |
| 3 – 5 years       |  | 15 | 19% |
| 5 – 10 years      |  | 10 | 13% |
| Over 10 years     |  | 7  | 9%  |

## CUSTODY STATUS

|                                   |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| No Contact / Total Loss of Access |  | 21 | 27% |
| Visitation Only                   |  | 19 | 25% |
| Children in Foster Care           |  | 14 | 18% |
| 50/50 Joint                       |  | 10 | 13% |
| Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)   |  | 6  | 8%  |

## GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

## TOP COUNTIES

|          |  |   |    |
|----------|--|---|----|
| Catoosa  |  | 5 | 6% |
| Gwinnett |  | 4 | 5% |
| Fulton   |  | 4 | 5% |
| Pierce   |  | 3 | 4% |
| Stephens |  | 3 | 4% |
| Cobb     |  | 2 | 3% |

## TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

|                                                                             |  |    |     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|----|-----|
| Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)         |  | 27 | 35% |
| High Conflict Divorce                                                       |  | 13 | 17% |
| Other: (Short answer)                                                       |  | 10 | 13% |
| False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report) |  | 7  | 9%  |
| Other                                                                       |  | 4  | 5%  |

## 05 PARENT VOICES — GEORGIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Georgia comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



*This crooked system paints a false picture of scarcity, and then throws a meaty bone between two parties who used to care about each other, profiting from them tearing each other apart over it. My wife and I are kind people who love Jesus and love our kids. That hasn't helped [...]*

— JOSHUA

## ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

The children have had to deal with the emotional turmoil that they reunification camp and the judge. The judge threatened the father and myself the stepmom, to jail for breaking the gag order, i won on appeal.

— GEORGIA PARENT · KITTY

## MORE VOICES FROM GEORGIA

My children have trauma and anxiety that never existed until DFCS was involved. Behavior issues now. My 4 year old son started wetting bed

— HALEY

Severed Mother son bond on zero facts all false allegations. Abuse of Power. My son is a weapon in family court and continues abuse.

— RHIANNON

Destroyed my whole life my kids are acting out violently towards each other mental health issues

— KELIA

It took an active and involved father away from a child's life and enabled the court to abuse a child with its default "legal" rules

— ANDY

My children were ripped away from me. Where they were going was planned long before court even happened. I wasn't given time to call family, they were going with my middle girls dad whom has 4 pending child abuse charges and battery. My 6 month old came home after 5 weeks with [...]

— APRIL

This system has caused my kids to be depressed. Feel like they are never coming home and almost caused me to have a stroke for the second time

— RHONDA

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*Lost time with my children that I'll never get back.*

— CRISTIN

Took my children away, instead of helping them with alienation, they allowed it to happen, the lies, everything. They didn't protect my children when they had a forensic interview proving that SA happened from step moms brother - court still allowed them around him.

— EMILY

If you like having you and your children's constitutional rights upheld, family court is not for you.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken precious moments that my children and I can never get back. Time cannot be reversed.

— ERIN

Ripped up a family that made me have purpose life with my 6 babies

— JOANNA

They allowed us to not be one. my kids have no education and do not know there real family who love and miss them.

— KARA

They have destroyed any security we once had in the Georgia medical system.

— PATRICIA

Destroyed my entire being inside and out. Made my kids think im crazy and dont love them. We lost all hope, trust, love and time. My kids didnt get to meet so many people who wanted and missed all the love and what family actually is.

— SAMANTHA

It has destroyed my families future in a few short months that I have worked decades trying to recover from prior bad actors in my life.

— LARRY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*Through false statements, unlawful actions, and complete disregard for due process, this system tore my family apart and deprived me of irreplaceable time with my children. What they took from us cannot be measured or undone.*

— SAMANTHA

Destroyed my rights to be a mother to my only child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped apart our bond, our loving relationship, our ability to be in each others lives, caused irreparable harm and emotional trauma to us all

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

— JENNIFER

Ignored mental health, , and financial abuse

— JENNA

Destroyed this family. We will never be the same or trust anyone ever again.

— BRANDON

Literally wripped us all apart. All living different lifes and being in so much pain for what we love and miss and belong and cant have eachother.

— BROOKE

Basically dealing with parent alienation and knowing mine and my daughter abuser is walking away free while I have to hide and hope he's no where around us because the system has failed us completely!

— TONIA

During one of the most vulnerable moments of my life—giving birth—I was separated from my children by decisions made in my absence, and I am still fighting to repair the harm done to my family.

— MARY

The family court system has served to destroy my family and my relationship with my daughter. It has enabled abusive spouses to continue in their abuse of both their spouse and the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court took my children without ever hearing the full truth, and it shattered something in me I can never get back. It drained me financially and emotionally until I was standing there with nothing left but the proof that I survived it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*My family has lost all faith in the United States government for not taking care of the hard working families of this country. The family court system is ran by judges that also see criminal cases.*

— RANDALL

My daughter lost her mom, 3 Siblings and suffered psychological trauma with educational disabilities and no medical care for a year

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Crying, willing to share by phone.

— HEIDI

Destroyed my family. Caused significant harm to my children. Smeared my name. Lost all of the money that was left to me from where my husband died overseas. Money that was left to take care of my children was lost to this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

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It is caused three years of excruciatingly, painful heartbreak for my children for me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system turned my child's abuser into the victim and ripped she and I apart. I became the villain that the community, friends, and even some of my family turned against because he seemed like such a nice guy. I was victimized by the system. My child was and is victimized by [...]

— AMANDA

This has almost killed me, mentally and physically. I have PTSD from it.

— DEBANIE

Destroyed my child's ability to feel protected and loved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

## 05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*This system has mentally ruined my children's sense of safety, they trust nobody, my baby screens every time he has to leave, we get treated like trash and belittled and never get to speak for ourselves even when they are blatantly lying. Ever time they give me a finish line [...]*

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The Gwinnett County Court system kidnapped my daughter.

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The system a lot for my children to stay alienated from me without doing anything about it. Money seems to be the only thing that matters in family court, not the welfare of anyone

— JOSHUA

After being dismissed and devalued by the system, in addition to the relationship abuse, I was ready to acquiesce and throw in the towel just to gain some semblance of my humanity back. I have zero faith in the justice system/courts after my experience.

— SARAH

Ruined the innocence of our child and ruined my life

— DOUG

The court never held the habitual absconding mother accountable to visitation violations.

— STEPHEN

Changed the entire dynamics of our entire life.

— KORTNEY

The system ignores true parental alienation. The system is broken and only relies on fast talking attorneys who only present one side of the information. Judges that are biased and small towns that probably have connections with specific families. This has robbed me of my mother [...]

— CHER

My kids and I will NEVER be the same! I thought the system would protect me but I was COMPLETELY wrong, losing precious time with my kids for over 10 years that I will NEVER get back is something I will always grieve over, Two out of 3 have aged out now finally!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

57 Georgia parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 46 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — GEORGIA**

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Georgia families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

This crooked system paints a false picture of scarcity, and then throws a meaty bone between two parties who used to care about each other, profiting from them tearing each other apart over it. My wife and I are kind people who love Jesus and love our kids. That hasn't helped us, it has hurt us. We maintain traditional biblical values for the family and our marriage, and those values were literally painted as dangerous by a guardian ad litem who got custody flipped on a sham temporary hearing with no proof of harm and actually testifying that our son is thriving. We have three cases in the system between us and our five children. Every experience has been vile. We have watched dishonest people get away with murder, and it not even matter when they get caught. Documented perjury has meant nothing. What could've been generational wealth has been destroyed. All while each children are used as pawns in a game purely played for money and control. Either the Constitution and the rights of guarantees mean everything, or they mean nothing. To the family court system, they mean nothing. There will be a lot of bad actors who have to stand before the Lord of Jesus one day and answer for the lives they have destroyed here on Earth. The family law system is the civil rights crisis of our time.

— JOSHUA

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**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

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— APRIL

The children have had to deal with the emotional turmoil that they reunification camp and the judge. The judge threatened the father and myself the stepmom, to jail for breaking the gag order, i won on appeal.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— AMANDA

This has almost killed me, mentally and physically. I have PTSD from it.

— DEBANIE

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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My kids and I will NEVER be the same! I thought the system would protect me but I was COMPLETELY wrong, losing precious time with my kids for over 10 years that I will NEVER get back is something I will always grieve over, Two out of 3 have aged out now finally!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has robbed me of being apart of my children's life and of time, life experiences that will never happen again, as well as falsifying everything and treating me as a criminal not to be trusted alone with my family. Now they are trying to sell them out of state in June.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

The system that I naively trusted stole my daughter's life and my family's.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Time I can never get back with my only child. Pain worse than death.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has cost my daughter and I time together. It has left her in a situation that she is unhappy and continues to cause detriment to her wellbeing

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore my family apart, cause generational trauma for years to come. My two children did not get to grow up together for the first three years of my youngest son's life, and that we faced challenges of building proper relationships, like siblings should naturally be able to do. I suffer with PTSD as well as physical difficulties due to my trauma manifesting physically.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Attempting to systematically deteriorate if not destroy a pre-existing full-time loving bond between a daughter of a tender age and her father through the state sanctioned licensing of paternal rights -- GA is the last of 50 states to still require un-wed fathers to formally beg the State Courts for permission to provide unconditional love, nurturing and support to their biological children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Medical coercion, violation of religious beliefs, covering up group home crimes, everything has been crooked including my public pretender

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

**06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED**

They have ripped our ggbabies away from our entire family with not a scared of evidence of anything. I had temp custody of the oldest girl's when she was a baby.Used a my innocence of how the system worked when they returned her to parents.Due to a lie by caseworker and used that again in this case.They gave temp custody in this case to maternal grandmother who is a known addict and convicted felony.She also done time in prison.

— LARAINÉ

“Despite the family court’s attempts to break me and the threats against my safety, I stand unwavering and unbowed, a testament to resilience and the indomitable spirit of a mother.”

— HANNAH

Torn us apart for being poor

— STEPHANIE

From the day I called the police for help, every single person that came in contact with my child and I, from law enforcement all the way to the church and everything in between has failed us. The system aided our abuser, opening the door for him to continue his path of abuse, and criminalized me for seeking refuge from this monster.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

57 full approved Georgia comments are included in this appendix.

## 07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

### WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Georgia report comes from Georgia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Georgia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

### WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 77 Georgia families reporting here are not the universe of Georgia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

### METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through [standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey](https://standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey). Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

### ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

STANDWITHMEG.COM | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.